It intensified operations against the militants after two attacks on General Pervez Musharraf in December 2003. In 2004, the Pakistan Army sustained heavy casualties (*New York Times*, 2006). In early 2005, it resorted to negotiations and peace deals with militants to avoid *Pashtun* backlash from the local populace and within the army cadres. Although the operations continued all along, all-out assault was avoided due to the following three reasons: (1) to avoid the dangers of battling multiple groups in multiple theatres in most rugged terrain; (2) a lack of consensus within the state and (3) a dearth of support from the Pakistani public (*The Nation*, 2009).

However, the turning point came when despite the peace deal with TTP in Swat and acceptance of their demand of imposition of Nizam-e-Adl (the justice system), the subversive and terrorist activities of Baitullah and Fazlullah continued unabated. In addition to immense US pressure, the public and the state realised the gravity of situation. Thus, the Pakistan Army started Operation 'Rah-e-Rast' (the virtuous path) against the Swat TTP on 26 April 2009 (*The Nation*, 2009).

All the military operations did not achieve a clear-cut victory because the insurgents' safe havens and supply lines were not neutralised.

Pakistan employed a motley of forces in its military operations against militants, including the army, the Frontier Corps, the Frontier Constabulary and the Frontier Police (Fair & Seth, 2010).

TTP compelled the Pakistan Army to fight a three-front war in the tribal areas: against TTP and IMU in South Waziristan; against anti-Shi'a Lashkar-e-Jhangvi in Darra Adam Khel-Kohat areas of KP and the Kurram Agency of FATA and against the TNSM and TTP Swat Chapter headed by Fazlullah and JeM in Swat Valley (Gurmeet, 2008).

### *Operation Kazha Punga (2002)*

The Pakistan Army undertook its first military adventure on 25 June 2002 to kill Commander Nek Muhammad and his local and foreign militants in South Waziristan. They had taken refuge in the area after the fall of the Taliban regime in Afghanistan in 2001. The objectives of the operation could not be achieved and the security forces faced tough resistance.

Half of the top-tier leadership of the Pakistani Taliban fled to Afghanistan to escape the military operations. Another objective that